

Nokia X30 5G

Unnecessarily expensive

After testing the Nokia X30 5G smartphone for about a week, I couldn't help but wonder if this smartphone is one of the products that just don't make sense in terms of their pricing. The Nokia X30 5G is priced at ₹47,999 in India, and for this price, you don't get your money's worth. Here's why:

DESIGN

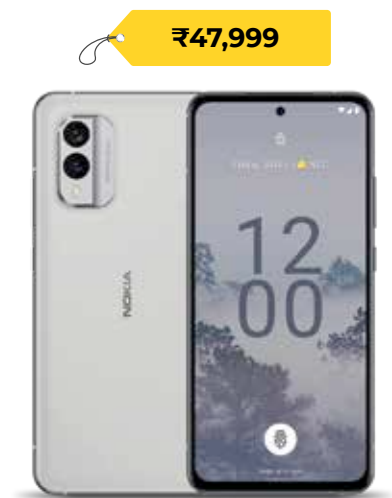
The Nokia X30 5G isn't too big or bulky, and it has a pretty good-looking back panel with a brushed silver camera module that sits proportionately on the top left corner of the back. The back panel is made of 65% recycled plastic. Nokia is going big on sustainability. The aluminium frame, is also made of 100 per cent recycled aluminium! That is good. Overall, this is a good design approach from Nokia. The smartphone is easy to hold and use with one hand, the in-hand feel is decent, and it is made of eco-friendly materials. The camera module also looks good with the grey-white dual-tone finish and sits proportionately at the top left corner of the back.

DISPLAY

The picture quality of this display is decent. The colours are a bit saturated and bright, but that gives it a very vibrant and bright feel. But the Nokia X30 5G does not support HDR, which is quite sad, since there are options under ₹20,000 also that offer HDR support. There's also no setting to change the picture mode of the device. You can't lock it at max 90. There are only two settings - 60Hz and "Adaptive." In our Lux Meter test, the Nokia X30 5G showed better numbers than the claim. We tested the highest brightness of 812 nits and a minimum of 4 nits on a plain white screen. Overall, the display is good but not as good as we'd expect from a sub-50k smartphone.

PERFORMANCE

Coming to performance, the Nokia X30 5G's benchmark numbers are much lower



than what we have seen on devices in this range this year. The Nokia X30 5G scored 400,969 points on the AnTuTu benchmark. On Geekbench, the smartphone gave a single-core score of 904 and a multi-core score of 2099. These numbers are minuscule in comparison with others in this category. On PC Mark, where the Nokia X30 5G scores 8,446 points, the cheaper OnePlus 11R scored 12,632. Coming to GPU-based tests, the Nokia X30 5G again didn't come close to the competition. The difference in numbers - is 1211 in 3D Mark Wildlife, where the OnePlus 11R maxed out. On 3D Mark Wildlife Extreme, the OnePlus 11R gave us a score of 2796 points. On the same test, the Nokia X30 5G gave us only 363 points. That is not all. The Nokia X30 5G doesn't even use the latest standards for RAM and storage. The storage benchmarks show underwhelming read and write speeds, and the smartphone's multi-tasking is also not as smooth as you'd expect. Coming to gaming, the Nokia X30 5G runs all games, and the experience was nothing more than average. On Call of Duty: Mobile, for example, the smartphone doesn't get the 'Ultra' setting for frame rate. The graphics look decent,

and the smartphone doesn't heat up too much while gaming. The smartphone runs on Android One, which is an almost stock Android, meaning there are no bloatware apps, no unnecessary features or permissions to deal with, and a very smooth and clean Android experience.

CAMERA

Coming to the camera, the images are decent, but not at par with the competition. In ideal lighting conditions, like a sunny day, or a well-lit room, the X30 5G takes good images. They are sharp, and the detail retention is also good. However, the camera struggles the moment lighting isn't ideal. In low-light shots, the images lack sharpness. We get a bit of a hazy texture, and the Nokia X30 5G's shutter speed becomes very slow to let more light in. There is a Night mode, of course, but that doesn't do much. If you want to get a good, consistent camera that performs well in all aspects and offers better functioning features, you can look elsewhere.

VERDICT

The Nokia X30 5G, is priced at ₹47,999 onwards in India, but we weren't able to find anything that justifies that price. Not to take away the credit, the Nokia X30 5G has a good design. However, the moment you turn the smartphone on, it does not feel premium at all. The display, the performance, the camera, the battery - there is nothing that justifies its price tag.

—Darab Mansoor Ali

SPECIFICATIONS

Display Size: 6.43 inch (16.33 cm) | Aspect ratio: 20:9 | Features: AMOLED, 90Hz refresh rate, Brightness 400 nits (typ.), 700 nits (peak) | Resolution: FHD+ 1080 x 2400 | Front camera: 16 MP, 1.0µm (2.0µm 4-in-1), f/2.4, 1/3.06" | Rear camera: 50 MP Main Big pixel with OIS 1.0µm (2.0µm 4-in-1), f/1.9, 1/1.57" + 13 MP Ultrawide 123°FoV f/2.4, 1/3.06" | Bluetooth: 5.1 | Battery: 4200 mAh | CPU: Snapdragon® 695 5G | Operating System: Android™ 12

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